

Absorbing sound

Heavy curtains and carpets can do a good job of absorbing most reflected sounds

Basic home theatres

Most consumer firms have home theatres starting at Rs. 15,000

Geek life

sary sound before it starts bouncing around the room.

For more natural bass and to handle lower frequencies, bass traps can be used in the corners of the room where bass is usually maximised. They can also be hung in corners of the ceiling for greater response. Other than professionally designed bass traps, something like a chair with big cushions can also do the job adequately.

Sound from a speaker may reach you through solid surfaces like the floor much faster than air. To avoid such issues, you need something to absorb the speaker's energy before it reaches the floor. Things like spiked feet, speaker absorption pads, plain foam, fibre glass or even a thick carpet will serve the purpose.

Speaker Placement

For a home theatre, at least a 5.1 or a 7.1 speaker system is a must to get the true surround sound experience. Speaker placement plays an important role in deciding how the system is going to sound. Ensure all speakers are pointed at the listening area and avoid any obstructions between the speaker and the seating location that may block or deflect the sound coming from the speakers.

5.1 SETUP

A 5.1 system consists of a five speaker channels and a sub-woofer (the .1). The sub-woofer can be placed anywhere in the room as long as it sounds good to you when placed there. The closer it is to a wall, the higher the bass output. Avoid



Diffusers prevent sound waves from reflecting over surfaces and creating distortion

putting it in a corner since that usually results in very heavy 'boomy' bass as well as in the middle of the room where it won't have much of an effect.

Move the sub-woofer around to different distances from the walls and listen to it from the seating area to figure out where it sounds best. A somewhat silly looking, but more accurate method is to place the sub-woofer at your listening area (after moving the sofa/chair) and go around the room near the floor looking for the place where the bass sounds just right. That's where you want to place the sub-woofer.

The centre speaker is the most important speaker in the setup since most of the dialogue comes through it. It should ideally be placed just above, or in case of a wall mounted TV, just below the screen facing the listeners, as close to ear level as possible.

DVD's usually contain 5.1 surround sound. Newer high definition formats like Blu-ray contain 7.1 surround sound

